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AP

■ Displaced Palestinians struggle to receive donated food for iftar on the first day of Ramadan at a community kitchen in Khan Younis, Gaza Strip, on Wednesday.

UAE pledges \$1.2 billion to support Gaza through the Board of Peace

Country among 9 who have pledged \$7 billion; US commits \$10 billion

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, announced that the UAE will provide \$1.2 billion to support Gaza through the Board of Peace.

Sheikh Abdullah made the announcement during his participation in the first meeting of the Board of Peace, chaired by US President Donald Trump in Washington.

Earlier, Trump announced

that nine members of the body had agreed to pledge \$7 billion towards a Gaza relief package for a war-battered Gaza, where a shaky ceasefire deal persists.

Other than the UAE, Kazakhstan, Azerbaijan, Morocco, Bahrain, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Uzbekistan and Kuwait are the countries that are making pledges, Trump added.

\$70 billion needed

"Every dollar spent is an investment in stability and the hope of new and harmonious (region)," said Trump in thanking the donors.

The amount, while significant, represents a fraction of the estimated \$70 billion needed to rebuild the Palestinian territory decimated after two years of war. Trump also announced the

US was pledging \$10 billion for the Board of Peace, but didn't specify what the money will be used for. "The Board of Peace is showing how a better future can be built, starting right here in this room," Trump said.

Indonesia, Morocco, Kazakhstan, Kosovo and Albania have pledged to send troops for Gaza stabilisation force, according to Maj. Gen. Jasper Jeffers, the commander of the international security force. Egypt and Jordan have committed to train police.

Troops will initially be deployed to Rafah, a major population centre where the US administration hopes to first focus reconstruction efforts.

The board was initiated as part of Trump's 20-point peace plan to end the conflict in Gaza.

SEE ALSO P6

Former prince Andrew arrested over misconduct

UK ROYAL HAS FACED ALLEGATIONS OVER LINKS TO JEFFREY EPSTEIN

DUBAI

BY ALEX ABRAHAM

Senior Associate Editor

Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor has been arrested by UK police on suspicion of misconduct in public office during his time as a trade envoy.

Police are currently considering allegations including that a woman was trafficked to the UK by the late sex offender Jeffrey Epstein for the former prince. Andrew has consistently and strenuously denied any wrongdoing.

The accusation came to light following the release in the US of documents relating to a trafficking investigation into Epstein. This is the first time the former prince, who has faced numerous allegations over this links to the convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, has been arrested.

Earlier, Prime Minister Keir

Starmer had said "nobody is above the law" when asked about Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor, but declined to say whether the former prince should volunteer himself to UK police.

The prime minister told BBC Breakfast the principle was "very important" and "has to apply in this case in the same way it would in any other case".

The arrest was a new blow for the ousted royal, who marked his 66th birthday yesterday.

Andrew was last year stripped of all his titles, having been forced out of his former home by his brother King Charles III.

As part of the investigation into Andrew, "we have today (19/2) arrested a man in his sixties from Norfolk on suspicion of misconduct in public office," Thames Valley police said in a statement, without naming the suspect, as is common practice in the UK.

SEE ALSO P7



FRIDAY

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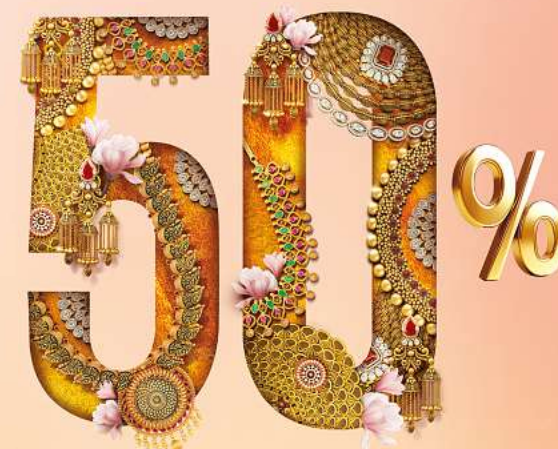


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